

Study Guide — Weeks 6–9 Deep + 1–5 Review

EAM310 · East Asian Medicine Diagnosis I · VUIM Summer 2026

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Weeks 6–9 (the Four Examinations) in full depth · Weeks 1–4 condensed to core recall

TCM for Ballroom Dancers

reMarkable Edition

How to use this guide: For students whose Weeks 1–5 material already feels solid. Weeks 1–4 here are consolidated recall tables only — go to the Full Cumulative Study Guide if any of it feels unfamiliar. Weeks 6–9 (Observation, Inquiry, Palpation, Hearing & Smelling) get the full treatment: real lecture depth, analogies, and every sub-table from the actual slides, since this is the newest and most commonly under-reviewed material. Week 5 is intentionally absent (midterm week, no new content).

1–4 · Weeks 1–4 Review — Condensed Recall

This version assumes Weeks 1–5 material is already solid from earlier review. These are consolidated recall tables, not full explanations — if any of this feels unfamiliar, go back to the Full Cumulative Study Guide for the complete treatment (analogies, mechanisms, source citations) before the final.

Week 1 — Vital Substances

Topic	Core Recall
Jing	Pre-Heaven (fixed, inherited, stored in Kidney) + Post-Heaven (replenished by Spleen/Stomach) = Kidney Essence. Deficiency = poor bone/brain development (children), weak knees/back, poor memory, tinnitus, premature greying, infertility (adults).
Qi formation	Air Qi + Food Qi → Zong Qi (chest) → Zhen Qi → splits into Ying Qi (nutritive, inside vessels) + Wei Qi (defensive, outside vessels).
6 functions of Qi	Transporting, Warming, Protecting, Holding, Transforming, Rising.
4 Qi patterns	Deficiency (fatigue, weak voice) · Sinking (organ prolapse) · Stagnation (distension>pain, Wiry pulse) · Rebellious (wrong-direction movement).
Qi Stag vs Blood Stasis	Qi Stag = more distension, moving, Wiry pulse. Blood Stasis = more pain, fixed/stabbing, purple tongue.
Blood patterns	Deficiency (pale, dizzy, scanty periods) · Stasis (stabbing fixed pain, purple tongue) · Heat in Blood (red tongue, bleeding) · Loss of Blood.
Fluids	Jin=Yang, clear/thin, Exterior, fast, Lung. Ye=Yin, turbid/dense, Interior, slow, Spleen/Kidney. Deficiency=dryness.
Five Spirits	Heart=Shén, Liver=Hún, Lung=Pò, Spleen=Yì, Kidney=Zhì.
Shen states	Having Shen=bright/alert. Loss of Shen=dull/confused. False Shen=sudden brightening before death, NOT recovery.

Week 2 — Eight Principles

Pair	Core Recall
Ext/Int	Exterior=fever+aversion to cold SIMULTANEOUSLY+Floating pulse. Loss of aversion to cold=moved Interior.
Def/Exc	Pressure is the key: Deficiency=relieved by pressure. Excess=aggravated by pressure.
Cold/Heat	Full Heat=whole face red+thick yellow coat. Empty Heat=malar flush only+no coat. Full Cold=strong aversion to cold. Empty Cold=desire for warmth+weakness.
False Heat/Cold	False Heat/True Cold: red cheeks "like powder," pulse Rapid-Floating-BUT-Empty. False Cold/True Heat: pulse Deep-Full despite cold limbs, chest/abdomen hot.
Collapse of Yang	Cold limbs, oily sweat, incontinence, Minute-Deep pulse.
Collapse of Yin	Hot limbs, abundant sweat, retention of urine/constipation, Floating-Empty-Rapid pulse.
Shao Yang	Half-Exterior/half-Interior — alternating cold and heat ("hot and cold, yes and no").

Week 3 — Pulse Diagnosis

Topic	Core Recall
Positions	L Cun=HT/SI, L Guan=LR/GB, L Chi=KD/BL. R Cun=LU/LI, R Guan=SP/ST, R Chi=PC/SJ (NOT KD-Yang directly).
Normal pulse	Wei (gentle)+Shen (rhythmic)+Gen (rooted, deep at Chi). 4–5 beats/breath.
Seasonal	Spring=Wiry, Summer=Flooding, Autumn=Hair-like, Winter=Stone. Out-of-season = warning sign.
Floating trap	Also = Yin Deficiency (Floating+Thin+Rapid, night sweats), not only Exterior.
Huan	The one healthy/normal quality among the 28 — 4 beats/breath, easy to mistake for Slow.
Irregular rhythm	Knotted=Slow+random stops (Cold). Hasty=Rapid+random stops (Heat). Intermittent=regular-interval pauses (most serious).
Key combos	Floating+Tight=Wind-Cold. Deep+Rapid=Int Heat. Rapid+Wiry=Liver Fire. Slow+Weak=Yang Deficiency. Slippery=Phlegm/Damp/pregnancy. Choppy=Blood Deficiency.

Week 4 — Tongue Diagnosis

Topic	Core Recall
4 aspects	Body color=Blood/Heat-Cold. Body shape=Blood/Qi state. Coating=Yang organs/Heat-Cold. Moisture=Body Fluids.

Color	Pale=Yang or Blood Def. Red+coating=Full Heat. Red, no coating=Empty Heat. Purple=ALWAYS Blood Stasis (reddish=from Heat, bluish=from Cold).
Shape	Thin=Blood/Yin Def. Swollen+pale+wet=Yang Def. Tooth-marked=Spleen Qi Def. Cracks=dryness/Yin Def (location determines organ).
Coating	Thick=pathogenic factor present, stronger=thicker. White=Cold. Yellow=Heat. Rootless=Stomach Qi/Yin Def. No coating=Yin Def.
Sublingual veins	Distended+dark=Blood Stasis Upper Burner. Thin=Yin Def. Dark+dry=severe Yin Def w/ Empty Heat.
Medications	Antibiotics=peeled patches. Corticosteroids=red/swollen. Chemo=thick brown/black dry coat.

5 · Week 6 — Diagnosis by Observation 望診

Schrier opens this unit with the legend of Biǎn Què, one of the earliest famous physicians in Chinese medical history, who was given a secret formula that let him "see through walls." His point: you're not getting X-ray vision from a cereal-box novelty, but you are developing the real version of that power. You've already started doing it with the tongue. Observation trains that same seeing-through-the-surface skill on the rest of the body.

Method

Method	Uses
Inspection	Eyes: vitality, color, appearance, secretions (incl. tongue)
Auscultation/Olfaction	Ears (listen) + nose (smell)
Inquiry	Verbal questioning
Palpation	Touch, incl. pulse

Quick Recall: Zang-Xiang = what's inside shows on the outside. The body is a microsystem of microsystems — face, tongue, ear, hand, and foot all independently map the whole body (distal acupuncture, e.g. LI4 for the head/face, works on this same "light switch across the room" principle).

Shen (Vitality) — Full Classification

Su Wen 43: the Shen is stored in the eyes; when restless, it withers and the sparkle fades. Schrier's illustration: even an unsettling character actor still has a visible twinkle on screen; the flat, empty stare of a mugshot or a horror-film "possessed" gaze is genuinely missing that light.

Category	Manifestation
Having Shen (yǒu shén)	Alert, bright eyes, clear consciousness and speech, quick responses, resonant voice, radiant complexion with natural expression
Fatigued Shen (shén pǐ)	Listlessness, lassitude, poor memory, weak/low voice, aversion to speaking, fatigue, slow and awkward actions
Loss of Shen (shǎo shén)	Dull eyes, slow/awkward action, blurred vision, dull complexion and expression, heaviness of the body, obtuse actions, mental confusion, unconsciousness, delirium, hallucinations
False Shen (jī shén)	In critical condition: listless, unconscious, dull eyes, low feeble voice, dull complexion, anorexia — THEN a sudden jolt: alert, bright eyes, louder voice, flushed cheeks, improved appetite

Observation	Having Shen	Loss of Shen	False Shen
Complexion	Bright and moist	Dim, dull sheen	Dull, then suddenly lustrous
Eyes	Alert, vivid, twinkle	Dull, blurred vision	Dull, then suddenly bright
Mind/Speech	Clear speech, conscious, agile	Unconscious, delirious	Unclear, then sudden change
Motion/Response	Quick, appropriate	Sluggish and slow	Suddenly responsive
Respiration	Even	Rapid, feeble, or difficult	Feeble, then briefly steady
Diet/Appetite	Strong	Poor	Improved (temporarily)

False Shen — back to the candle: a low-burning candle can flare brighter right before going out — like a sailor's "green flash" at sunset. Schrier's family story: a dying relative held on, fully alert and vocal, until one last sibling arrived, then passed shortly after. False Shen is the fire's last flare, not a genuine turnaround.

Deranged Shen Patterns

Term	Presentation
Fán zào	Irritability with hot/feverish sensation; may drive the patient to prefer nudity or jump into water
Zàng zào (Visceral Agitation)	Mental depression, hallucination, disorientation, frequent crying spells, bouts of yawning, no loss of consciousness
Bǎi hé bìng (Lily disease)	Chronic depression, apathy, aversion to speaking/mumbling to self, insomnia, anorexia, sleepwalking
Diān (Yin madness)	Chronic depression, aversion to speaking or mumbling to self, inappropriate laughing/crying
Kuáng (Yang madness)	Raving with obscenities, restlessness, singing loudly in high places, wandering naked, hitting people or destroying things

Su Wen 32 — Face Heat Map

Schrier's holiday mnemonic: "why does Rudolph have a red nose? Why does Santa?" — too many cookies, Spleen-associated Heat (nose maps to Spleen).

Region (patient's own left/right)	Organ
L cheek (patient's)	Liver
Forehead	Heart
Nose	Spleen
R cheek (patient's)	Lung
Chin	Kidney

The mirror trap: a near-guaranteed quiz item. Drawing the face map facing yourself puts Liver on YOUR left as you look at the page — but that's the patient's left cheek. Schrier admits marking his own quizzes wrong on this.

Complexion Variables & Attributes

Concept	Detail
Facial Color	Color of the skin; associated with Blood and Yin
Facial Sheen	Luster of the skin, moisture; associated with Qi and Yang
Constitutional (True) Color	The individual's inherent color, unchanged during life
Guest/Visitor Color	Slight changes following seasonal/climatic shifts, environment, or physical activity
Normal Complexion	Subtle, slightly reddish hue; "contained" color with gentle luster

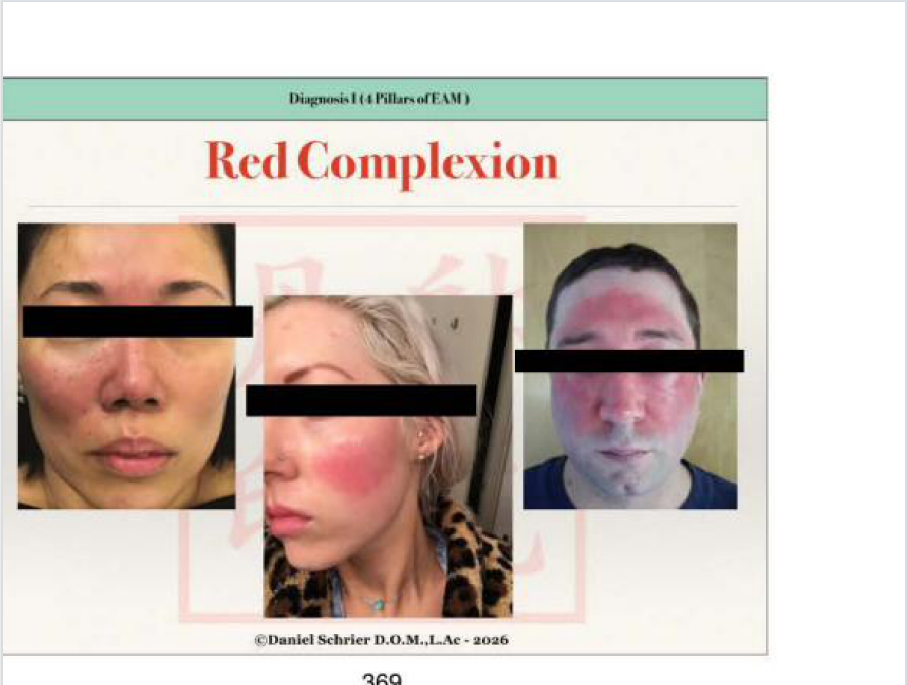
Attribute	Finding	Indication
Brightness	Dull/dim	Cold or Dark pattern; Yin pattern
Thickness	Thick color	Excess pattern
Thickness	Thin color	Deficiency pattern

Five Colors of the Face — Full Sub-Variants

Variant	Indication
Pale White/Dull White (withered)	Qi or Blood Deficiency
Bright White (puffy, bloated)	Yang Deficiency
Pale Blue-White	Cold with Yang Deficiency

Yellow Variant	Indication
Bright Yellow (Yang jaundice)	Damp-Heat
Dull/Dark Yellow (Yin jaundice)	Cold-Damp / Spleen deficiency

Red Variant	Indication
Red over entire face	Full/Excess Heat
Red cheeks (malar) only	Empty/Deficient Heat
Superficial zygomatic flush with pale face beneath	Floating Yang (serious – Yin failing to hold Yang down)



Red Complexion presentations (redacted for privacy) — Prof. Schrier's Week 6 slides. Used for internal class study only.

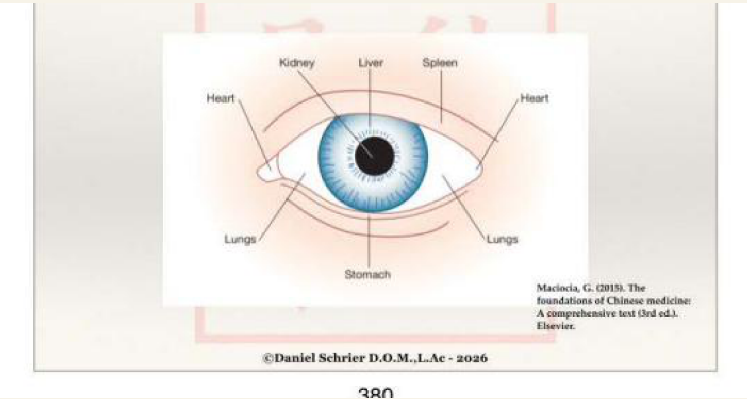
Green Variant	Indication
Pale green under eyes	Liver Qi Stagnation (also seen as Liver Blood Deficiency, per location)
Green on cheeks	Liver Qi Stagnation, Liver Blood Stasis, Cold in Liver, or Liver Wind
Green with red tinge	Shao Yang pattern (TH/GB)
Green with red eyes	Liver Fire
Yellow-green cheeks	Phlegm with Liver Yang Rising
Green nose	Stagnation of Qi with abdominal pain
Dark red-green	Stagnant Liver Qi turning into Heat

Black/Grayish Variant	Indication
Dark (black) and dry	Kidney Yin Deficiency with Empty Heat
Dark and dried up/burnt	Kidney Essence exhaustion
Black without luster, dry and scaly	Kidney Yang Deficiency
Black around the eyes	Kidney Deficiency or Blood Stasis

Inspection of the Eyes

Ling Shu 80: "the essence from the five Zang and six Fu flow upwards to irrigate the eyes." The Liver opens into the eyes and stores the Blood that allows the Mind to see and distinguish color; tears moisten the eyes under Liver governance.

Significance of Eye Inspection
Identify pathogenic factors and thermal nature · Identify the Zang-Fu organs involved · Understand the current state of those organs · Make a prognosis



Five Wheels of the Eye — source: Maciocia, *Foundations of Chinese Medicine* (3rd ed.), via Prof. Schrier's Week 6 slides.

Wheel	Structure	Organ
Blood	Inner/outer canthus	Heart
Qi	Sclera (white)	Lung
Wind	Iris	Liver
Water	Pupil	Kidney
Flesh	Eyelids	Spleen

Ling Shu (Qi Bo's reply): "the essence of the bones collects in the pupils; the essence of the sinews collects in the black parts (iris); the essence of the blood collects in the network vessels (canthi); the essence of the qi collects in the white of the eyes (sclera); the essence of the sinews and flesh collects in the eyelids."

Inspecting the Shen of the Eye

	Manifestation	Indications	Prognosis
Having Shen	Clear vision, bright shiny luster, distinguishable iris/pupil, clear flexible movement, little tear/eye secretion	Strong Liver and Kidney Qi; Mild Illness	Good, relatively easy to treat
Lack of Shen	Poor vision, dull luster, turbid hue in sclera/iris/pupil, borders indistinguishable, no tears or secretion	Poor Liver and Kidney Qi; Stronger illness	Poor, relatively difficult to treat

Eye Color Diagnosis

Yellow in Sclera/Eyes	Accompanying Signs	Indication
Bright yellow, tangerine-peel	Thirst, dry mouth, heat, bitter taste, epigastric fullness, sticky taste, heaviness; T: Red sticky coat; P: Slippery Rapid	Damp-Heat, Heat predominant
Dull yellow	Thirst w/o desire to drink, epigastric fullness, sticky taste, heaviness; T: Sticky yellow; P: Slippery Rapid	Damp-Heat, Damp predominant
Dull dark yellow	Thirst w/o desire, epigastric fullness, cold limbs; T: Sticky white; P: Slippery Slow	Cold and Damp
Deep yellow, bloodshot	Fever, feeling of heat, agitation, red skin rashes, headache; T: Red w/ points, thick coat; P: Slippery Rapid Overflowing	Toxic Heat
Dark dull yellow/brown	Dark rings under eyes, headache, abdominal pain, agitation; T: Purple; P: Wiry Choppy	Blood Stasis

Red in Eyes	Location/Accompanying	Indication
Red in canthus area	—	Heat in the Heart
Redness and swelling, entire eye	Headache, easily angered	Rising Liver Fire or exterior Wind-Heat
Red sclera	Cough	Heat in the Lung

Blue-Green/Dark in Eyes	Accompanying Signs	Indication
Blue-green sclera	Tinnitus, headache, numbness of limbs; T: Stiff/Deviated; P: Wiry	Liver Wind
—	Abdominal pain, chronic pain, abundant pale urine; T: Pale; P: Tight and Slow	Internal Cold
—	Poor memory, night sweating, dry mouth/throat, low back ache, scanty dark urine, tiredness; T: Normal, no coat; P: Floating Empty	Kidney Yin Deficiency
Dark sclera, black eye sockets	Obesity, dizziness, sensation of heaviness in the head, feeling of muzziness, weakness, cold limbs	Retention of Turbid Phlegm; Yang Deficiency with Liver/Kidney Yin issues
Dark, brownish sclera	Dizziness, tinnitus, irritability, red tongue, thirst	Liver and Kidney Deficiency

White in Eyes	Accompanying Signs	Indication
White rings around iris	—	Liver and Kidney Yin Deficiency
Iris gradually turning white	Dim vision, cold limbs, loose stools	Yang Deficiency
Pale white blood vessels in canthus	Pale tongue and face	Blood Deficiency

Color	General Mechanism (Overview)
Red	Pathogenic Heat injuring blood vessels or causing Blood to rise upward
White	Lack of Blood to fill the vessels (Qi/Blood Deficiency, or Yang Deficiency with Cold obstructing vessels)
Yellow	Liver/Gallbladder obstructed by Dampness or Qi/Blood stasis, generating Heat that steams bile and rises to the eyes
Black	Extreme Heat consuming Body Fluids and concentrating the Blood; also associated with Kidney failure
Blue-Green	Wind or Liver dysfunction

Eye Shape & Movement

Finding	Indication
Sunken (general)	Less nourishment and support
Sunken, following prolonged vomiting	Spleen Qi Deficiency; or Collapse of Yin/Yang (severe cases)
Swollen (Heat/Damp accumulation)	Sudden onset, red/swollen/itchy, possible sores = Wind-Heat toxin; puffy without pain, shiny/colorless = Edema/Water retention; slow painless swelling both lids = Spleen deficiency with Damp
Bulging (general)	Exuberant Zheng Qi struggling against excessive pathogens, pushing the eyeball outward
Bulging + headache/irritability, red tongue, yellow greasy coat	Liver Yang Rising with Heat
Bulging + neck swelling, dizziness, tinnitus, five-center heat	Yin Deficiency with relative Yang Excess
Bulging + neck swelling, headache, double vision, purple tongue w/ spots	Blood Stagnation
Strabismus, sudden, no redness/swelling, one eye, w/ deviated mouth	Wind attacking the channels
Strabismus + nausea, fatigue, chest tightness, greasy coat, slippery pulse	Damp-Phlegm obstructing the channels
Eyelid spasm, thin/pale face and lips, thready pulse	Blood Deficiency
Eyelid spasm + frequent blinking, heaviness/fatigue, poor appetite, flabby tongue	Spleen Deficiency with Dampness
Drooping eyelid, slow onset, fatigue, organ prolapse, weak pulse	Qi Sinking
Drooping eyelid, acute onset, itching/numbness, aversion to cold/fever, floating pulse	Wind attacking the channels

Hair

Finding	Indication
Falling hair	Kidney Jing or Blood Deficiency
Prematurely greying hair	Kidney Essence Deficiency
Dull and brittle hair	Liver Blood Deficiency

Quick Recall: hair state reflects Blood or Kidney Essence — Schrier connects this directly to why national leaders visibly grey so fast in office: chronic stress burns Kidney Essence "at both ends."

Nose

Finding	Indication
Green/blue tip	Abdominal pain from Cold
Yellow tip	Damp-Heat in the Spleen
Red tip	Heat in Lung and Spleen
Greenish bridge	Liver-Qi stagnation
Red bridge	Liver Fire
Slightly moist and shiny	Good prognosis
Dry nose	Heat in Stomach or Large Intestine
Clear watery discharge	Cold pattern
Thick yellow discharge	Heat pattern (with some Dampness)
Flaring nostrils + high fever	Extreme Heat in the Lungs
Epistaxis (nosebleed)	Excess Heat attacking Lung and Stomach

Ears

Finding	Indication
Swelling & pain, middle ear	Heat in Shao Yang (TH/GB) channels
Thin ear	Deficiency of Qi or Blood
Long, full ear lobe	Strong constitution
Small lobe	Poor constitution
White ears	Cold pattern
Bluish/dark ears	Pain caused by Cold
Dry, withered, dark lobes	Exhaustion of Kidney-Qi (usually Kidney-Yin)
Shiny, moist lobes	Good prognosis
Dry, withered lobes	Poor prognosis

Ear Discharge	Indication
Clear	Cold
Foul, purulent	Damp-Heat
Bloody	Heat
Yellow	Damp accumulation

Teeth & Gums

Teeth Finding	Indication
Dry, without sheen	Kidney Deficiency, Body Fluid injury
Dull, like a "soy bean"	Severe Kidney failure/exhaustion
Loose teeth	Kidney Deficiency

Gum Finding	Indication
Moist, normal	Normal
Deep red with swelling	Excess Heat in Yang Ming
Atrophied gums	Kidney Deficiency
Ulceration or bleeding, with pain/swelling	Stomach Fire Rising
Chronic bleeding, no pain	Blood Deficiency
Dark line between teeth and gums	Heavy metal (e.g. mercury) poisoning

Lips & Mouth

Normal lips are red, lustrous, and moist — neither swollen nor atrophied, neither deviated nor shaking, with free flexible movement.

Finding	Indication
Pale lips + pale tongue	Blood Deficiency or Yang Deficiency
Pale lips + fatigue	Qi Deficiency
Crimson lips	Deficiency Heat
Purple lips	Interior Cold or Blood Stasis
Swollen lips, thirst with desire to drink	Excess Interior Heat
Swollen lips, no thirst	Spleen/Stomach Dampness
Chapped/dry lips	Lung/Stomach Fluid damage or Wind due to Stomach Fire
Deviated mouth, one side, no pain	Wind attack in the collaterals
Deviated mouth + bitter taste, red face	Heat toxins injuring the collaterals
Sudden open mouth, drooling, loss of consciousness	Wind-Phlegm (critical)
Mouth closed tightly (trismus)	Wind

Throat, Pharynx & Tonsils

Finding	Indication
Deep red	Heat (interior or exterior)
Pale red	Empty-Heat
Acute pain, redness, swelling	Invasion of Wind-Heat
Chronic pain, redness, swelling	Stomach-Heat
Chronically sore/dry, not swollen or red	Lung and/or Kidney Yin Deficiency with Empty-Heat
Chronic erosion, raised hard-edged ulcers	Blood Stasis with Phlegm-Heat

Swollen tonsils, normal color	Damp/Phlegm retention against a background of Qi Deficiency
Acutely red, swollen tonsils with exudate	Wind-Heat invasion complicated by Toxic Heat in Stomach/Large Intestine
Grey-ish tonsils	Acute stage of glandular fever (mononucleosis)

Limbs, Joints & Movement Disorders

Category	Pattern
Edema, hands	Lung-Yang Deficiency
Edema, feet	Kidney-Yang Deficiency
Edema, all four limbs	Spleen-Yang Deficiency
Edema, non-pitting	Retention of Dampness or Qi Stagnation
Acute hand edema	Invasion of Lungs by Wind-Water
Flaccidity (soft, limp, not atrophied)	Wind-Heat injuring Lung/Body Fluids (acute); Damp-Heat in Stomach/Spleen; Spleen/Stomach Qi Deficiency; Kidney-Yin Deficiency
Rigidity, sudden onset	Invasion of Wind
Rigidity, chronic, elderly	Liver-Yang Rising or Liver-Wind
Rigidity + pain worse at night	Blood Stasis
Paralysis, main causes	Stomach/Spleen Deficiency; Liver/Kidney Yin Deficiency; Dampness w/ Heat (Full); Phlegm and internal Wind in channels (with underlying Qi/Blood Deficiency)
Contraction, sudden	Invasion of Wind (Full: Dampness obstructing muscles/fluids)
Contraction, chronic	Liver-Blood or Liver-Yin Deficiency (Empty)
Tremor of the hands	Liver-Wind
Tremor, elderly, all limbs	Liver-Wind and Phlegm affecting channels/sinews
Fine tremor in women	Liver-Wind from Liver-Blood Deficiency
Mild fine tremor	General Qi/Blood Deficiency
Spasticity + tremor in febrile disease	Liver-Wind or Empty-Wind from Yin Deficiency

Nails

Finding	Indication
Normal	Rosy, shiny, appropriately thick, without roughness
Nail bed white on pressure, color returns immediately	Sufficient Qi and Blood (normal)
White on pressure, color returns slowly	Exhaustion of Qi and Blood
Pale color	Deficiency (Qi/Blood)
Purple/bluish color	Blood Stasis
Rough, thick, lusterless, loss of transparency	Qi/Blood Deficiency w/ Wind attack or Damp invasion causing stagnation
Ridges	Blood Deficiency with Liver-Yang Rising, or Qi/Blood Deficiency
Hook-shaped	Qi/Blood stagnation or Wind-painful obstruction
Spoon-shaped	Malnutrition, Spleen Deficiency
Twisted and bent	Liver-Qi Deficiency or Liver-Blood stagnation

Thenar Eminence Vein Color	Indication
Bluish, veins visible	Cold in the Stomach
Bluish and short	Empty pattern
Red veins	Heat in the Stomach
Purple veins	Blood Stasis in the Stomach

Skin

Skin Color	Indication
Jaundice, bright yellow	Yang Jaundice, Damp-Heat
Jaundice, dull yellow	Yin Jaundice, Cold-Damp
White patches, clear margin	Vitiligo from Wind-Damp attack disharmonizing Qi and Blood

Skin Moisture	Indication
Normal moisture	Exuberance of Lung Qi, sufficient Body Fluids
Generalized dry skin	Blood or Body Fluid Deficiency
Dry skin with scales	Blood Stasis

Skin Lesion	Description
Papule (zhěn)	"Rash," seed-sized, red, distinct borders, raised, color disappears with pressure
Macule (bān)	"Plaque," flat, red patch, clear border, does not disappear with pressure
Blister (pào zhěn)	Raised surface, varies in size, contains clear or turbid fluid
Nodule (jiǒ jié)	Localized, felt under the skin

Quick Recall (Excreta/Secretions general rule): white/clear/thin/formless/no odor = Cold or Deficiency. Yellow/thick/strong odor = Heat or Excess.

Demeanor & Body Movements

Finding	Pattern
Excess of movement	Yang/Full/Heat
Lack of movement	Yin/Empty/Cold
Quick movements + feeling of Heat	Excess Yang
Small movements, continuous fidgeting (esp. legs)	Empty-Heat
Tremors, convulsions	Liver-Wind (Full-Wind)
Fine tremors, tics	Liver-Wind (Empty-Wind)
Paralysis	Internal Wind
Stiffness and rigidity	Qi stagnation, Blood stasis, or internal Wind

Body Shape

Finding	Pattern
Large, barrel-like chest/epigastrium	Full condition of Lungs and/or Stomach
Large, overweight thighs	Spleen deficiency
Thin body overall	Yin deficiency
Overweight body overall	Yang deficiency with Phlegm

6 · Week 7 — Diagnosis by Inquiry 問診

Schrier opens by naming a historical precedent for tailoring the question order: Zhāng Zhòngjǐng always started with Cold and Fever — essentially asking "is this an Exterior or an Interior pattern?" before anything else. Schrier's own approach is looser: follow the patient's chief complaint first, then let that complaint's logic dictate which of the 16 Questions actually matter. He also encourages asking what's going well in the patient's life, not only what's wrong — and stresses that lifestyle questions (work hours, caregiving burden, commute) often explain a pattern on their own: someone caring for an ill parent who commutes hours each way, works all day, and finally gets to bed near midnight only to wake at 3am to do it again doesn't need any other explanation for a Qi and Blood deficiency picture.

Topic	Detail
10 vs 16 Questions	Maciocia's 10: chills/fever, sweating, head/body, 2 excretions, diet, chest/abdomen, hearing, thirst/drink, previous illness, cause. Schrier's 16 adds Pain, Emotions, Sexual Symptoms, Energy Level.
Golden Rule	Every question should confirm or exclude a pattern — never recite the 16 as a rote script; always ask why.

1) Pain

Topic	Detail
3 mechanisms (Neijing)	Circulation impeded (Su Wen 39) · Tension (Su Wen 39/62, Ling Shu 10) · Lack of nourishment
Full vs Empty pain	Full: aggravated by food/BM/vomiting/pressure, relieved by rest, sharp, worse w/ movement. Empty: alleviated by food/BM/rest/pressure, dull, better w/ movement.
Pain character	Distending/moving=Qi stagnation · boring/stabbing fixed=Blood stasis · cramping+cold=Cold · burning+fullness=Heat · intense+fullness=food retention

Wandering Bi — the hot dog cart analogy: Schrier's image for Wind-type Bi Syndrome: paying a food-truck vendor on a windy day and your money blows out of your hand — it drifts one way, you chase it, it flips another way. That's Wind: pain that isn't anchored anywhere, moving joint to joint.

Bi Syndrome	Pathogen	Character
Wandering	Wind	Moves joint to joint, nothing fixed
Painful	Cold	Severe, fixed pain
Fixed	Damp	Soreness and heaviness
Heat	Heat	Sudden onset, swelling, redness
Bone	Chronic, deep	Progression of the other four; joint deformity

Table 24.1 Factor	Empty	Full	Cold	Heat
Food	Alleviated	Aggravated	—	—
Character	Lingering ache	Sharp	Cramping	Burning
Temperature	—	—	Alleviated by heat	Alleviated by cold
Bowel movement	Alleviated	Aggravated	Alleviated	Aggravated
Pressure/Posture	Better lying down	Better sitting up	—	—
Vomiting	Alleviated	Aggravated	Alleviated	Aggravated
Rest/movement	Better with rest	Better with movement	Better with movement	Worse with movement

Table 24.2 Cause	Organs Affected	Locations
Qi stagnation	Liver, Stomach, Intestines	Epigastrium, abdomen
Blood stasis	Liver, Uterus, Heart, Stomach, Intestines	Head, chest, epigastrium, abdomen, Uterus
Liver–Yang rising	Liver	Head
Retention of food	Stomach, Intestines	Epigastrium, abdomen
Cold	Stomach, Uterus, Intestines	Epigastrium, Uterus, abdomen, joints
Damp–Heat	Stomach, Uterus, Intestines, Bladder, GB	Hypochondrium, epigastrium, abdomen, hypogastrium, joints
External Wind	—	Whole body, joints
External Dampness	Stomach, Intestines, Uterus	Head, epigastrium, abdomen, Uterus, joints

Phlegm	Stomach, Intestines, Uterus	Head, epigastrium, abdomen, joints
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Su Wen 39 mechanisms: Cold outside the conduit (Blood diminished, Qi can't pass) · pain relieved by pressure (Cold Qi guests between Stomach/Intestine, dispersed on compression) · pain unrelieved by pressure (Cold Qi guests deep along the spine) · referred pain to heart region (Cold Qi in Back-Shu conduit draining to Heart) · pain radiating to genitals/back (Cold Qi in Jueyin, wraps genitals, links to Liver).

2) Food & Taste

Schrier widens "appetite" beyond food itself: the Stomach's job is reception — receiving food and drink, but by extension, receiving information. Ravenous appetite doesn't automatically mean Stomach Fire either — he flags parasites (tapeworms) as a real differential to rule out first.

Topic	Mapping
Appetite	Lack=SP-Qi def · excessive=ST-Heat (rule out parasites first) · fullness=Dampness/food retention · distention=Qi stagnation
Taste	Bitter=Liver/Heart Heat · sweet=SP def or Damp-Heat · sour=food retention or LR invading ST · salty=KD-Yin def · pungent=LU-Heat
Vomiting, general	Relieved by eating=Empty; aggravated by eating=Full
Vomiting, taste/quality	Sour=Liver invading Stomach · Bitter=Liver/GB Heat · Clear/watery=Cold in Stomach · Soon after eating=Heat in Stomach
Vomiting, force	Sudden/forceful=Full · Slow/weak=Empty

3) Stools & Urine

Finding	Pattern
Better after BM	Full condition
Worse after BM	Empty condition
Difficulty BM, stools not dry	Liver-Qi stagnation
Constipation + abdominal pain	Internal Cold (Full or Empty)
Constipation, dry stool, small sips of fluid	Yin deficiency (Kidney/Stomach)
Desire but inability to pass stool	Central Qi (Stomach/Spleen) deficiency with sinking Spleen-Qi
Alternating constipation/diarrhea	Stagnant Liver-Qi invading Spleen
Chronic diarrhea, very early morning	Kidney-Yang deficiency ("cock's crow diarrhea")
Diarrhea + abdominal pain	Interior Cold in the Intestines
Diarrhea with mucus	Dampness in Intestines
Diarrhea with mucus and blood	Damp-Heat in Intestines
Undigested food in stool	Spleen-Qi deficiency
Black or very dark stools	Blood stasis
Blood first, bright red, splashing	Heat in the Blood
Blood first, turbid, painful anus	Damp-Heat in Intestines
Stool first then watery blood	Spleen-Qi deficient, unable to hold Blood
Foul-smelling stools	Heat
Absence of smell	Cold
Borborygmus + loose stools	Spleen deficiency
Borborygmus + distention, no loose stools	Liver-Qi stagnation

Flatulence, foul smell	Damp-Heat or retention of food
Flatulence, no smell	Interior Cold from Spleen-Yang deficiency
Urine color: pale/dark/turbid	Pale=Cold · dark=Heat · turbid/cloudy=Dampness
Pain before/during/after urination	Before=Qi stagnation Lower Burner · during=Damp-Heat Bladder · after=Qi deficiency
Enuresis/incontinence	Kidney deficiency
Retention of urine	Dampness in Bladder (occasionally Lung-Qi deficiency)
Very frequent, copious urination	Kidney-Yang deficiency
Frequent, scanty urination	Qi deficiency
Scanty, dark urine	Kidney-Yin deficiency

4) Thirst & Drink

Finding	Pattern
Desire for cold drinks	Heat
Desire for warm liquids	Cold
Absence of thirst	Cold, or no Heat present
Thirst with no desire to drink	Damp-Heat or Yin deficiency

5) Energy Level

"I'm so tired" is, in Schrier's words, not enough information — "tell me more" does most of the diagnostic work. Chronic tiredness with a desire to lie down, poor appetite, and loose stools points toward Spleen Deficiency; the same complaint with a weak voice and a tendency to catch colds points toward Lung-Qi Deficiency instead — because Lung and Spleen are the two organs generating postnatal Qi.

Presentation	Pattern
AM worse	Spleen/Stomach-Yang deficiency
Weak voice, catches colds easily	Lung-Qi deficiency
Feeling cold	Kidney-Yang deficiency
Dizziness, blurred vision, scanty periods	Liver-Blood deficiency
Malar flush, red tongue no coating	Kidney-Yin deficiency
Heaviness	Dampness
Muzzy head, dizziness	Phlegm
Distention, irritability, Wiry pulse	Liver-Qi stagnation
Short bouts, alternating hot/cold, irritability	Shao Yang pattern

6) Head, Face & Body

Schrier repeats the mint-tea caveat from Week 1 here: mint tea disperses Liver-Qi stagnation and helps an Excess-type headache, but the same cooling, dispersing action worsens a Deficiency-type headache. Know which kind you're looking at first.

Headache Location	Channel	Cause
Nape	Tai Yang	Ext. Wind-Cold or Kidney def
Forehead	Yang Ming	Stomach-Heat or Blood def
Temples/sides	Shao Yang	Ext. Wind or Liver/GB Fire rising
Vertex	Jue Yin	Liver-Blood deficiency

Headache Onset/Timing	Pattern	
Recent, short duration	Exterior Wind-Cold attack	
Gradual, in attacks	Interior type	
Daytime	Qi/Yang deficiency	
Evening	Blood/Yin deficiency	
Night-time	Blood stasis	

Headache Quality	Pattern	
Empty, dull, back of brain to neck	Kidney deficiency	
Distending, throbbing	Liver-Yang rising	
Boring, nail-like point	Blood stasis	
Muzziness and heaviness	Dampness	
Muzziness, heaviness, dizziness	Phlegm	
Numbness, bilateral vs unilateral	Bilateral=Blood deficiency; Unilateral (esp. first 3 fingers)=Internal Wind+Phlegm, possible impending Wind-stroke	

Dizziness	Pattern	
Severe, loses balance	Internal Wind, Liver-Yang rising	
Slight, worse when tired	Blood deficiency	
Sudden vs gradual onset	Full vs Empty pattern	

Face & Related	Finding	Pattern
Facial pain, acute, heat	—	Invasion of Wind-Heat
Facial pain, spastic, sneezing, aversion to cold	—	Invasion of Wind-Cold
Facial pain, chronic	—	Qi deficiency and Blood stasis in the channel
Runny nose	Clear, thin	Wind-Cold
Runny nose	Thick, sticky, yellow	Wind-Heat or Damp-Heat in Stomach
Bleeding gums	+ tiredness, poor appetite, loose stool	Deficient Spleen-Qi not holding Blood
Bleeding gums	+ inflamed, heat, thirst	Stomach Full-Heat
Bleeding gums	+ dizziness, tinnitus, night sweat	Kidney-Yin deficiency with Empty-Heat
Mouth ulcers	Red-rimmed on gums	Stomach Full-Heat
Mouth ulcers	Pale-rimmed on gums	Stomach Empty-Heat
Mouth ulcers	Tip of tongue	Heart-Fire or Heart Empty-Heat
Cold sores	Sudden, burning	Stomach Heat
Cold sores	Recurring for years	Stomach Empty-Heat
Cold sores	Pale, aggravated by overwork	Qi deficiency

Body	Finding	Pattern
Whole body pain	Sudden, aversion to cold, fever	Exterior Wind invasion
Whole body pain	Ache + tiredness	Qi-Blood deficiency
Back pain	Continuous, dull, better with rest	Kidney deficiency
Back pain	Recent, severe, stabbing	Blood stasis
Back pain	Worse cold/damp, better with heat	Invasion of exterior Cold-Damp

Bleeding Mechanism (general)	Accompanying Signs	Pattern
Excess pushing blood out	Feeling of heat, thirst, inflamed gums	Fire/Heat (Excess)
Deficiency, not holding	Tiredness, poor appetite, loose stools	Spleen-Qi not holding Blood (Deficiency)
Deficiency Heat	Dry mouth, small sips not gulping	Yin Deficiency with Empty Heat

Quick Recall: bleeding has three root mechanisms — too much Heat pushing Blood out, too much tension forcing it out, or a Deficiency failing to hold it in.

7) Chest & Abdomen

Region	Finding	Pattern
Chest	Stabbing pain	Heart Blood Stasis
Chest	Pain + cough + yellow sputum	Phlegm-Heat in the Lungs
Chest	Oppression	Phlegm obstructing Lungs, or Liver-Qi stagnation
Hypochondrium	Distention	Liver-Qi stagnation
Hypochondrium	Stabbing	Blood stasis
Epigastrium	Dull, alleviated by eating	Empty/Deficiency
Epigastrium	Severe, aggravated by eating	Full/Excess (food retention, Stomach Heat/Fire, Phlegm-Fire, Blood stasis, Liver-Qi invading)
Epigastrium	Fullness/heaviness	Dampness
Lower abdomen	Relieved by BM	Full Condition
Lower abdomen	Aggravated by BM	Empty Condition
Hypogastrium	Pain	Damp-Heat in the Bladder

8) Limbs

Finding	Pattern
Wandering, shifting, aching	Wind
Severe, fixed, worse w/ cold	Cold
Heavy aching, immobile joints	Dampness
Redness, swelling, heaviness	Heat
Tingling sensation	Blood deficiency
Numbness, unilateral	Wind or Wind-Phlegm
Atrophy/flaccidity, early stage	Stomach and Spleen-Qi deficiency
Atrophy/flaccidity, later stage	Liver/Kidney Yin deficiency or Spleen/Kidney Yang deficiency
Tremor	Always Liver-Wind (Excess or Deficiency type)
Cold hands + palpitations/dizziness	Heart-Blood deficiency
Cold fingers/toes	Liver-Qi stagnation
Cold feet, women	Liver-Blood deficiency
Weak knees	Kidney deficiency (esp. Kidney-Yang)
Feeling of heaviness, all 4 limbs	Dampness; combined w/ Stomach-Qi def if severe

9) Sleep

Finding	Pattern
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Sleepy after eating	Spleen–Qi deficiency
General lethargy, heaviness of body	Retention of Dampness
Extreme lethargy + feeling cold	Kidney–Yang deficiency
Lethargic stupor, rattling throat, slippery pulse	Phlegm misting the Mind
Can't fall/stay asleep	Blood deficiency not anchoring Shen/Hun (Empty)
Restless, heat, excessive dreaming	Pathogens agitating Shen/Hun (Full)
Waking many times at night	Yin deficiency with Empty Heat (Heart, Liver, or Kidney)
Waking early, can't return to sleep	Gall Bladder deficiency
Insomnia + night sweats + palpitations	Heart and Kidney Yin deficiency with Empty–Heat
Dream–disturbed sleep	Liver–Fire or Heart–Fire
Restless sleep, excessive dreams	Retention of food

Not tested: Categories of Dreams / Neijing dream chapters (Su Wen 17, 80; Ling Shu 43) are explicitly marked "Bonus Material, Will Not Be Tested."

10) Sweating

Area/Quality	Pattern
Head only	Heat in Stomach, or Damp–Heat; if profuse/critical = Collapse of Yang
Arms and legs only	Stomach and Spleen deficiency
Whole body	Lung–Qi deficiency
Palms, soles, chest	Yin deficiency (five–palm heat)
Daytime	Yang deficiency
Night–time	Yin deficiency (occasionally Damp–Heat)
Profuse cold sweat, severe illness	Collapse of Yang
Oily sweat on forehead like pearls	Collapse of Yang — danger of imminent death
Yellow sweat	Damp–Heat

11) Ears & Eyes

Finding	Pattern
Tinnitus, sudden onset, worse w/ pressure	Full — Liver–Fire, Liver–Yang rising, or Liver–Wind
Tinnitus, gradual onset, better w/ pressure	Empty — Kidney deficiency
Tinnitus, loud/high–pitched (whistle)	Liver–Yang, Liver–Fire, or Liver–Wind
Tinnitus, low–pitched (rushing water)	Kidney deficiency
Deafness, sudden	Full — Liver–Fire/Yang/Wind
Deafness, gradual	Empty — Kidney deficiency, Heart–Blood or Qi of Upper Burner
Eye pain, swelling, redness	Invasion of Wind–Heat or Liver–Fire

Eye feeling of pressure	Kidney–Yin deficiency
Blurred vision + floaters	Liver–Blood, Liver–Yin, or Kidney–Yin deficiency
Blurred vision + photophobia	Liver–Blood deficiency or Liver–Yang rising
Dry eyes	Liver and/or Kidney Yin deficiency

12) Cold, Heat & Fever

Pattern	Corresponds To
Simultaneous aversion to cold + fever	Tai Yang stage / Wei Level — the key sign of Exterior invasion
Feeling of heat, no aversion to cold	Pathogen has entered the Interior
Alternating cold and heat	Shao Yang stage (GB/TH)

Fever intensity reflects the STRUGGLE between Zheng Qi and the pathogen, not which pathogen it is: both strong = high fever; both weak = low fever; Zheng Qi weaker than pathogen = medium fever.

Feeling	Detail	Pattern
Cold	Limbs and abdomen	Spleen/Stomach–Yang deficiency
Cold	Hands/feet, esp. fingers	Liver–Qi stagnation
Cold	Hands and chest	Heart–Blood or Yang deficiency
Cold	Legs/knees/feet/back	Kidney–Yang deficiency
Heat	Afternoon/evening	Empty–Heat (Yin deficiency)
Heat	Low-grade, constant	Damp–Heat
Heat	Middle of the night	Yin deficiency

13) Emotional Symptoms

Depression Type	Pattern
+ insomnia, palpitations, weak limbs, loose stool	Spleen and Heart–Blood deficiency (Empty)
+ palpitations, cold hands	Heart–Yang deficiency (Empty)
+ moodiness, irritability	Liver–Qi stagnation (Full)
+ irritability, red tongue	Stagnant Liver–Qi turning into Heat (Full)
+ lump-in-throat sensation, swollen tongue	Phlegm–Fire harassing the Mind (Full)
+ palpitations, agitation, purple tongue	Heart Blood Stasis (Full)

Anxiety Type	Pattern
+ insomnia, palpitations	Heart–Blood deficiency
+ timidity	Heart and Gall Bladder Qi deficiency
+ hypochondrial distention	Liver–Qi Stagnation (Full)
+ headache at temples, tinnitus, dizziness	Liver–Yang rising (Full)
+ red eyes, bitter taste, dark urine	Liver–Fire (Full)
+ manic behavior, swollen tongue	Phlegm–Fire Harassing the Mind (Full)

Other Emotion	Associated Patterns
Irritability/Anger	Qi stagnation, Blood stasis, Liver–Yang rising, Blood deficiency, Yin deficiency, Heat/Damp–Heat
Worry/Overthinking	Heart and Spleen Qi deficiency, Lung–Qi deficiency, Heart–Blood/Liver–Blood deficiency, Heart–Yin deficiency w/ Empty–Heat
Sadness/Grief	Lung and Heart Qi deficiency, Liver–Blood or Heart–Blood deficiency

14) Sexual Symptoms

Men	Pattern
Impotence + cold, backache, clear urine	Kidney–Yang Deficiency
Impotence + dizziness, palpitations, choppy pulse	Heart–Blood Deficiency
Impotence + tiredness/ dizziness after ejaculation	Heart–Fire
Impotence + scrotal heaviness, discharge	Damp–Heat in the Liver channel
Premature ejaculation	Kidney Yang/Qi, Spleen, Heart–Qi/Blood, or Lung deficiency
Tiredness/dizziness after ejaculation	Liver–Qi stagnation, or Kidney deficiency

Women	Pattern
Lack of libido/ anorgasmia	Kidney or Heart deficiency, Kidney–Yang deficiency
Excessive desire	Liver or Heart–Fire, Empty–Heat from Kidney–Yin deficiency
Headache after orgasm	Rebellious Qi of the Chong Mai, or Heart–Fire

15) Women’s Health

Aspect	Finding	Pattern
Cycle	Always early	Blood–Heat or Qi deficiency
Cycle	Always late	Blood deficiency, Blood stagnation, or Cold
Cycle	Irregular	Liver–Qi stagnation or Liver/Spleen deficiency
Amount	Profuse	Blood–Heat or Qi deficiency
Amount	Scanty	Blood deficiency, Blood stagnation, or Cold
Color	Pale/light–red	Blood–Heat (bright) or Blood deficiency (pale)
Color	Purple/blackish	Blood or Cold stasis
Color	Fresh red	Empty–Heat from Yin deficiency
Quality	Congealed with clots	Stasis of Blood or Cold
Quality	Watery	Blood or Yin deficiency
Quality	Turbid	Blood–Heat or Cold stagnation
Pain timing	Before / During / After period	Qi or Blood stagnation / Blood–Heat or Cold stagnation / Blood deficiency
Leukorrhea	White, thin, watery	Spleen–Yang or Kidney–Yang deficiency
Leukorrhea	Greenish–yellow, thick/sticky	Damp–Heat in Liver channel
Leukorrhea	Watery	Cold–Damp
Infertility	—	Blood/Kidney–Essence deficiency, Damp–Phlegm in Lower Burner, Blood stasis or Cold in Uterus
Miscarriage, before 3 months	—	Blood or Essence deficiency

Miscarriage, after 3 months	—	Liver–Blood stasis or sinking Spleen–Qi
Postpartum: nausea + heavy bleeding	—	Exhaustion of the Chong Mai
Postpartum: sweating + fever	—	Exhaustion of Qi and Blood
Postpartum depression	—	Heart–Blood deficiency

16) Children's Health

Finding	Pattern
Abdominal pain	Cold in Stomach/Intestines, or Qi stagnation
Vomiting milk, colic (babies)	Retention of food
Cough, wheezing, earache	Wind attacking the Lungs
Chronic cough, sticky sputum	Damp–Phlegm in Lungs
Skin rash, insomnia, character change	Latent Heat
Chronic earache	Damp–Heat in Gall Bladder channel
Disturbed sleep + crying (babies)	Retention of food or Stomach–Heat
Disturbed sleep (older children)	Liver–Fire or Stomach–Heat

7 · Week 8 — Diagnosis by Palpation 切診 (non-pulse)

Schrier frames palpation as giving you access to information the other three pillars can't: the state of the channels themselves, trigger points, adhesions, and structural findings you simply cannot see or ask about. His teaching method for this unit is heavily hands-on — students spend much of the class actually palpating each other's forearms, lower legs, and abdomens rather than only reviewing slides.

Channel Palpation — the Beaver Dam and the Gummy Bear

Schrier compares an obstructed channel to a beaver dam: Qi backs up behind the blockage, and when you release it (needling the point), the pent-up flow can come through forcefully enough that a patient feels a jolt somewhere distant — the classic experience of needling the arm and feeling it in the opposite-side toe, following the paired six-conformation relationships. For nodules found along a channel, his practical texture test is gummy bears: is it soft and squishy (fresher, more moist) or hard and stale, like a gummy bear left out of the package on the counter too long? That texture distinction maps onto Phlegm (softer) versus Blood Stasis or Cold (harder, more congealed).

Technique	Method	Finding → Meaning
Channel tracing	Palpate forearm (wrist→elbow) and lower leg (ankle→knee) three times, pressing progressively deeper each pass — light, medium, deep (Heaven, Earth, Humanity)	Structural changes, muscle tension, nodules, lumpiness along the pathway
Pressing (Ashi)	Thumb/fingertip pressure along the channel and at points	Tenderness/pain = Excess. Feels good under pressure = still some stagnation, but with an underlying Deficiency component — "the more it feels good, the more something's stuck that wants to move." Slippery or hard = Phlegm.
Feeling	Temperature, moisture, skin texture	Rough (like a cat's tongue or lizard skin), sticky/gummy, or the presence of rashes along a channel's course all localize to that channel's associated organ or region

Quick Recall: palpate moving upward along the direction of the Five Transport (Wu Shu) points — from fingers/toes toward elbows/knees — not downward; this is a diagnostic convention distinct from Qigong energy work, which can move either direction.

Skin Temperature — Why the Back of the Hand Goes First

Schrier's practical tip: check temperature with the back of your hand before the palm, because the back of the hand runs cooler and gives you a more accurate baseline reading rather than one skewed by your own palm's warmth. He also cautions that clothing and room temperature can distort the reading — a patient wearing a heavy sweatshirt on one side of the body, or sitting in a cold exam room, can present a temperature difference that has nothing to do with their underlying pattern. Always account for the room and the layers before concluding anything.

Presentation	Pattern
Cold	Cold pattern
Hot on 1st touch, cools w/ sustained pressure	Exterior Wind-Heat, still only at the Wei (exterior) level
Hot over the blood vessel on medium pressure, not heavy	Interior Heat in the Middle Burner/Heart
Hot on heavy pressure, nearly reaching the bone	Empty-Heat from Yin Deficiency — the extreme form of this is "steaming bone disorder," where heat feels like it's radiating from the bone itself
Hot dorsal (back of hand)	Full Heat (Ling Shu 74)
Hot palm	Empty Heat (Ling Shu 74)

Hands and Feet

Finding	Pattern
Cold hands and feet, warm torso	Liver Qi Stagnation — the Liver isn't ensuring smooth Qi flow to the extremities, so warmth stays trapped centrally
Cold hands	Lung and/or Heart Yang Deficiency
Cold feet	Kidney (Yang) Deficiency
Cold feet, in women specifically	Liver Blood Deficiency
Cold fingers and toes	Liver Qi Stagnation

Xu Li (Apical Beat) — The Pool Ladder Test

The apical beat is the pulse of the heart/left ventricle, felt at the fifth intercostal space. Schrier's analogy for the region just below the xiphoid process (reflecting the Upper Burner and Zong Qi): a set of pool ladder steps. If you press your thumb straight through a worn stair tread with no resistance, that structure has failed — too soft, too giving, which maps to Deficiency. A healthy structure has just enough give without being rigid — too hard and unyielding maps to Full/stagnation.

Presentation	Pattern
Clear/slow	Normal
Feeble	Zong Qi deficiency
Strong/hard	Excess Lung/Heart
Large but empty	Heart-Qi deficiency
Stop-start	Severe shock or alcoholism; poor prognosis if discrepant from the radial pulse
Rapid	Shock, fright, or sudden anger

Abdominal & Point Palpation

Schrier traces the abdominal map to the same cosmological Five-Phase layout used for the face and pulse, but notes it wasn't fully developed until Japanese practitioners — particularly the blind acupuncturist Waichi Sugiyama — extended the foundational work found in the Nan Jing and Shang Han Lun. Sugiyama is also credited (per the story Schrier tells, acknowledging it's more legend than verified fact) with inventing the guide tube after a fall down a ravine left a pine needle wrapped in a leaf pressed against his skin — giving him the idea for a way to insert needles with far less pain than his own famously rough technique. Practical courtesy point: never palpate straight down a patient's abdomen from the pubic bone without warning — ask them to place their own hand at the top of the pubic bone (CV3) as a landmark, and work from CV17 downward to the umbilicus, and from CV3 upward to the umbilicus, rather than palpating across that boundary directly.

Topic	Detail
Nan Jing 5-Phase map	Above navel (Ren 12–15)=Heart/Fire · at navel=Spleen/Earth · below navel (Ren 7–Pubis)=Kidney/Water · R side under ribs=Lung/Metal · L side under ribs=Liver/Wood
Normal abdomen	Solid-not-hard, resilient-not-tight, elastic-not-soft (the "pool ladder" test). Hard+pain worse w/ pressure=Full. Too-soft+ache relieved=Empty. Fixed masses=Blood stasis.
Palpating lumps (channel, breast-adjacent, abdominal)	Soft=Phlegm · Hard=Blood Stasis or Cold congealing · Distinct edges=Phlegm · Indistinct edges=Toxic Heat · Mobile=Phlegm-Damp · Immobile=Blood Stasis or Toxic Heat
Front-Mu vs Back-Shu	Front-Mu (alarm points) = where Qi of the organs collects/accumulates, more associated with treating Excess. Back-Shu = stronger Qi reserve, often better for Deficiency, though also used to clear Excess.
Front-Mu numbering mnemonic	Higher rib-cage points correspond to upper-body organs and lower-numbered points near the sternum/chest; a quick way to sanity-check a Back-Shu point's location is that lower numbers (BL 13) sit higher on the back (Lung) and higher numbers (BL 28) sit lower (Bladder) — upper, middle, and lower Burner order top to bottom.

Aggressive Energy (Worsley system): a non-classical addition Schrier includes because some students will encounter it in Five Element/Worsley-influenced clinics. AE is described as toxic Qi circulating through the Ke (control) cycle; under the fingertip it reportedly feels like the buzzing vibration of an electric razor at specific Back-Shu points (BL 13, 14, 15, 18, 20, 23). Diagnosis is confirmed only through the treatment itself — needling the point plus a nearby "test needle" and watching for erythema (redness) that lingers around the main needle longer than around the test needle. This is not on the national boards; it's included as clinical color for those who go on to study Five Element/Worsley-style acupuncture.

Palpating the Chest

Finding	Pattern
Tender at CV17 with light palpation	Heart Blood Stasis (or, depending on location, Lung Excess)
Tenderness relieved by light palpation	Deficiency
Tenderness relieved by light palpation but elicited by deeper palpation	Mixed Deficiency and Excess
Tenderness increases with deeper palpation	Excess

Palpating the Three Jiao (Burners)

The goal isn't necessarily to find "normal" (evenly warm) — Schrier's clinical preference is actually for a uniform temperature across all three Burners, even if that uniform temperature is cold or hot throughout, over a lopsided picture (e.g., a very cold Lower Burner beneath a hot Middle and Upper Burner). A uniform imbalance is, paradoxically, more internally consistent and often more straightforward to treat than a split thermostat within the same body.

Burner	Location	Contains
Upper	Above the diaphragm	Heart, Pericardium, Lungs
Middle	Between diaphragm and navel	Stomach, Spleen, Liver, Gallbladder
Lower	Below the navel	Small Intestine, Large Intestine, Bladder, Kidney

Channel Palpation in the Classics

Concept
Involves tracing the pathways of the 12 primary channels to determine the quality of Qi and Blood flow. Discussed in: Huang Di Nei Jing (Su Wen 20; Ling Shu 20, 51, 73, 75), Nan Jing 13, Zhang Zhongjing's Shang Han Lun, Sun Simiao's Qian Jin Yao Fang, Li Shizhen's Qijing Ba Mai Kao.
What Palpation Can Tell Us
Stagnations (local or generalized) · Ashi/trigger points · Channel involvement · Severity of condition · Organ/ligament health, flexibility, location · Adhesions/obstructions (stagnation, blockage, dampness)

Skin Moisture & Texture

Finding	Indication
Moist skin	Invasion of exterior Wind

Moist, no exterior symptoms	Lung-Qi deficiency
Dry skin	Blood deficiency or Yin deficiency
Rough skin	Bi Zheng/Painful Obstruction Syndrome from Wind
Scaly and dry skin	Exhaustion of Body Fluids or severe Liver-Blood deficiency
Swollen, pitting	"Water swelling" — Spleen and/or Kidney Yang deficiency
Swollen, non-pitting	"Qi swelling" — Dampness or Qi stagnation

8 · Week 9 — Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling
聞診

Wén Zhén is the second of the Four Diagnostic Methods (望聞問切) and has two distinct components sharing one character (聞 — "to perceive with the ear/nose"). Schrier is explicit about what you're actually doing with the smelling component in practice: you are not smelling a patient's urine, stool, sputum, or vaginal discharge. You ask them what these things smell like, since they have direct access to that information and you generally don't (sweat and breath being the practical exceptions you might notice directly in the room).

Component	Covers
Hearing	Voice, breathing, cough, vomiting, hiccup, borborygmi, sighing, belching — any sound emitted by the patient
Smelling	Body odor, and odor of bodily secretions (breath, sweat, sputum, urine/stools, vaginal discharge, intestinal gas)

Voice & Zang-Fu Relationship

Schrier separates the voice's production from its volume: the Lung is the gateway of the voice, moving Qi to create sound in the first place, while the Kidney is the root of the voice, controlling volume because it's the root of Yuan Qi and governs the Qi's reception once the Lung sends it down. He offers a "Jimmy" story to illustrate Wood/shouting-style assertiveness: a substitute teacher, trying to get his attention, kept calling him by the wrong name ("Jimmy") with increasing frustration, eventually smacking the desk to demand a response — assertive, forceful, attention-demanding, without necessarily being angry. That forcefulness (not necessarily volume alone) is the signature of the Wood/Shouting sound.

Organ	Role	Governs
Lung	Gateway of the voice; movement of Qi helps create sounds	Production of sound
Kidney	Root of the voice; root of Yuan Qi	Volume of the voice
Spleen/Stomach	Acquired root of Qi	Strength of the voice

Voice, Breathing & Reflexive Sound Patterns

Schrier tells a story about his cat, nicknamed "Darth Vader" for her labored, raspy breathing, caused (it turned out, after years of tests) by a large nasal polyp; once it was surgically removed, the sound disappeared entirely. The point for clinical practice: an abnormal respiratory sound is real diagnostic data even when its cause isn't obvious right away, and structural causes should stay on the differential alongside pattern-based ones.

Presentation	Pattern
Loud voice	Full or Heat pattern — think of how your own voice sounds when you're truly angry and trying to make someone stop: forceful, loud, hot
Weak voice	Empty or Cold pattern
Reluctance to talk	Cold pattern or Lung-Qi deficiency — Cold slows everything down, including the will to speak
Excessive talking	Heat — Schrier's example: children as "little hot buckets," constantly narrating everything ("did you know I can stand on my toes?"); adults who talk excessively often report feeling warm or overheated while doing it
Sudden loss of voice	Invasion of Wind-Heat
Gradual loss of voice	Lung-Qi or Lung-Yin deficiency
Coarse, loud breathing	Full pattern
Weak, thin breathing	Empty pattern
Loud, explosive cough	Full pattern
Weak cough	Empty pattern
Borborygmi (stomach gurgling)	Loud=Full; low/weak=Empty (Spleen/Kidney Yang deficiency)

Five Element Sounds — With Cultural Illustrations

Schrier uses broad, explicitly non-judgmental cultural comparisons to make these sounds memorable: he describes German speech patterns as leaning Wood/assertive (direct, forceful, even in affectionate expressions), Welsh speech as carrying a Fire-like rising-and-falling melodic quality, and Japanese cultural precision (tea ceremony, sword forms, bento box arrangement) as exemplifying Metal's clean, exact, single-motion perfection. These are teaching illustrations of the sound-quality associations, not clinical claims about any individual patient's constitution.

Sound	Element	Quality
Shouting	Wood	Forceful, attention-demanding, assertive (not necessarily angry)
Laughing	Fire	Outward, bursting expression — including the "pre-laugh" giggle a child gives before they even finish telling a joke
Singing	Earth	Soothing, nurturing, rises and falls gently — the voice you use calming a child or an anxious animal
Weeping	Metal	Consumes/dissolves Qi; a voice on the verge of tears, choking back words
Groaning	Water	Flat, stretched, little modulation — like a VHS tape played back slowed down

Diagnosis by Smelling

Odor	Description / Indication
Rancid/Sour	Fat no longer fresh; also smell of newly-mown grass; prickling effect on the nose
Scorched	Burnt toast, clothes from the dryer, a scorched shirt while ironing
Fragrant	Related to pleasant smells like flowers, but not as pleasing — cloying, sickly sweet, tends to linger
Rotten	Rotting meat; fills the nose with tiny prickles
Putrid	Similar to rotting meat but sharper/more aggressive; smell of stagnant water

Schrier's distinction for a true Cold-Damp "fishy" odor: not the aggressive smell of a Chinatown fish market, but the very light, mild, faintly salty smell of a freshly caught fish held up and sniffed directly — subtle, not pungent. Strong, intense odor generally points toward Heat/Excess; faint or absent odor toward Cold/Deficiency. He repeats the gravy-thickening-on-the-stove image from earlier weeks for the consistency of vaginal discharge/leucorrhea: watery (thin, like gravy mix fresh in cold water) points to Cold/Deficiency, while thick and sticky (like gravy reduced too long on the heat) points to Heat/Damp.

Secretion	Finding	Pattern
Breath	Strong, foul	Stomach Heat or retention of food
Sweat	Putrid-smelling	Damp-Heat
Sputum	Strong-smelling, rotten	Phlegm-Heat or Toxic Heat
Sputum	Fishy-smelling	Lung-Heat
Urine	Heavy smell of urea, scanty yellow	Heart fire pouring into Bladder
Urine	Clear, frequent, odorless	Cold
Vaginal discharge	Strong-smelling, leathery, thick/sticky	Damp-Heat
Vaginal discharge	Fishy smell, thin/watery	Damp-Cold

Flag: the Scorched odor slide uses 笑 (xiào) where the classical character is 焦 (jiāo) — confirm with Prof. Schrier before the final. The Five Named Odors are not explicitly paired to Zang-Fu organs in the source slides.

Borborygmi, Yawning & Sighing — Detail

Sound	Finding	Pattern
Borborygmi	Loud (Full), usually with diarrhea/dysentery	Cold-Damp in Middle Burner, Phlegm-Damp in MB, Liver/Spleen disharmony, or Damp-Heat in Stomach/Intestines
Borborygmi	Low (Empty)	Spleen/Kidney Yang deficiency, Middle Burner Qi deficiency
Yawning	Frequent, loud, relieved after, induced by emotion	Liver-Qi Stagnation
Yawning	+ chest pain, after injury/chronic illness	Blood and Qi Stagnation
Yawning	Infrequent, weak or no sound	Spleen/Kidney Yang Deficiency

Sighing	General	Qi stagnation of the Liver or Lungs, often from emotional causes: repressed anger/ frustration (Liver) or worry/sadness (Lungs)
Sighing	Weak sound	Deficiency of Spleen and Heart, deriving from sadness, grief, or pensiveness

Voice — Five Element Sounds, Expanded

Sound	Detail
Singing	Occurs naturally when soothing a child or distressed animal/person; increased pitch variation, goes up and down more frequently
Weeping	Consumes/dissolves Qi; more a non-verbal, emotionally expressive sound; speaking-with-a-weep can turn to crying; may show as choking back or faltering words
Groaning	Little movement or modulation; flat, as if the normal ups and downs of the voice have been squeezed out

Panting, Abnormal Respiration & Cough

Finding	Pattern
Panting, Excess	Irregular respiration, full chest, loud rough sound, uneven exhalation — Xie Qi obstructing the Lung
Panting, Deficiency	Timid breath, low voice, diminished inhalation/increased exhalation, worse with movement — Kidney deficiency (can't absorb Qi) or Lung deficiency (can't govern Qi)
Asthma	Lung-Qi's failure to descend
Wheezing	Lung-Qi fails to descend with Phlegm obstruction
Upper Stifling	Lung-Qi rises upward to the throat, obstructing the air tract
Shortness of breath	Lung-Qi deficiency, or Water Retention in the Chest (coughing watery sputum)
Cough, loud/explosive	Full pattern
Cough, weak	Empty pattern
Cough, dry	Lung-Yin deficiency
Unproductive vs Productive cough	Sound without phlegm = unproductive; phlegm with sound = productive
Sneezing, acute/loud/constant	Heat and/or Excess condition
Sneezing, chronic, soft	Lung-Qi deficiency
Sneezing, sudden in critical illness	Yang-Qi recovery (positive sign)

Vomiting, Hiccup, Belching & Their Differentiation

Finding	Pattern
Vomiting, slow/low/faint/forceless	Deficiency and/or Cold pattern (often Stomach deficiency and Cold)
Vomiting, sudden/loud/forceful	Excess and/or Heat pattern (often Stomach-Heat)
Hiccup, loud	Full pattern, often Liver-Qi invading Stomach
Hiccup, quiet/low	Empty pattern, often Stomach-Qi or Stomach-Yin deficiency
Belching, loud and long	Full — retention of food, Stomach-Heat, or Liver-Qi invading Stomach
Belching, short and low	Deficiency — Stomach-Qi deficiency (± Cold)

Symptom	Mechanism	Distinguishing Feature
Vomiting	Rebellious Stomach-Qi	Food, fluid, or sputum flows up from the Stomach and out of the mouth, with sound
Belching	Rebellious Stomach-Qi	Air/gas flows up from the stomach, makes sound passing through the throat
Hiccup	Rebellious Stomach-Qi	Involuntary diaphragm spasms causing a short sound

Body Odor & Five-Element Odor Detection

Odor	Pattern
Goatish	Wind, Dampness, Heat accumulation
Foul stinking	Epidemic infectious disease, or Summer-Heat toxin
Foul in the armpit	Damp-Heat accumulation

Five-Element odors typically appear only when the patient undresses, especially detectable on the back. Body odors reflect the patient's actual pattern, which may not match their constitutional Element type.

Odor of Secretions — Full Reference

Secretion	Finding	Pattern
Breath	Strong, foul	Stomach Heat or retention of food
Breath	Sour	Retention of food, Accumulation Disorder
Breath	Foul, pungent	Damp-Heat in Stomach and Spleen
Breath	Rotten	Damp-Heat in Large Intestine
Breath	Fishy	Phlegm-Heat in Lung
Sweat	Strong-smelling	Damp-Heat
Sweat	Putrid-smelling	Disease of the Lungs, Liver, or Kidneys
Sputum	Strong, rotten	Heat in Lungs, usually Phlegm-Heat or Toxic Heat
Sputum	Fishy	Lung-Heat
Sputum	Odorless	Cold
Stool	Extremely stinky + pus/blood + flatulence	Damp-Heat in the Intestines
Stool	Sour, foul, with indigestion	Food stagnation
Stool	Fishy with loose stools	Cold in Spleen/Stomach
Flatulence	Slight/odorless, worse with stress	Liver-Qi stagnation
Flatulence	Rancid, rotten (rotten eggs)	Toxic Heat in Large Intestine
Stool/flatulence	Abnormal color, no/weak odor	Stomach/Large Intestine Qi deficiency
Urine	Frequent, urgent, painful, burning, turbid yellow	Damp-Heat in Bladder
Urine	Heavy urea smell, scanty yellow	Heart-Fire pouring into Bladder
Urine	Clear, frequent, odorless or slightly fishy	Kidney deficiency
Urine	Odorless incontinence	Exhaustion of Kidney-Fire
Vaginal discharge	Strong, leathery	Damp-Heat
Vaginal discharge	Fishy	Damp-Cold
Lochia (postpartum)	Strong smelling	Damp-Heat or Toxic Heat in the Uterus
Nose discharge	Yellow, sticky, foul	Heat in Lung, or Damp-Heat in Spleen/Stomach
Ear discharge	Foul, fishy, turbid pus	Damp-Heat in the ear
Eyes	Red, swollen, turbid tears, foul/fishy odor	Damp-Heat in the Liver channel